Approved software list and licensing

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Summary

This article explains how Acme Global's approved software list works, how users can locate and install permitted applications through the Company Portal, and what steps the Service Desk should follow when a request falls outside the list. It covers verification of successful installation and when to escalate to the Application Support or Security teams for further review.

Symptoms

- Software Center shows the message "This application is not available for your device"
- Installation attempt returns error 0x80070005 (access denied) or 0x80070002 (file not found)
- Prompt for administrator credentials appears even though the user is a standard account
- Notification: "Software is not on the approved list; please submit a request for review"

Common causes

- The requested application is not included in Acme Global's approved software list
- A required license has not been assigned to the user or device
- The application is pending security review by the Application Support or Security Operations team
- Intune policy has not yet refreshed on the device (up to 8 hours)
- The user lacks the necessary Intune role to install line-of-business apps

Understanding the Approved Software List

Acme Global maintains an approved software catalog that is synchronized with Microsoft Intune's Company Portal. Only applications that have passed licensing, security, and compatibility reviews appear in the catalog. This ensures uniform patching, reduces malware risk, and helps the finance team track software spend. The list is reviewed quarterly, and new titles are added after a formal request is evaluated by the Application Support group, with security validation from Security Operations when needed.

Self-Help: Request or Install Approved Software via Company Portal

If you need a standard application that is already approved, you can install it yourself using the Company Portal app or web portal. Follow the steps below to locate the software, initiate the install, and confirm completion. If the application does not appear, proceed to the Service Desk section for a formal request.

Service Desk Procedure: Handling Software Installation Requests

When a user reports that approved software is missing or installation fails, the Service Desk follows a structured workflow to verify eligibility, attempt remediation, and, if necessary, escalate for licensing or security review.

1. 1. Open the Company Portal app from the Start menu (Windows) or Applications folder (macOS), or go to https://portal.manage.microsoft.com and sign in with your Acme credentials.
2. 2. In the search bar, type the name of the application you need (e.g., "Python", "Adobe Reader", "Visual Studio Code").
3. 3. If the app appears in the results, select it and click the **Install** button. The portal will show a progress bar; installation typically completes within 5-15 minutes depending on size.
4. 4. After the status changes to **Installed**, launch the program from the Start menu or Applications folder to verify it runs correctly.
5. 5. If the installation fails or the app is not listed, note any error message and contact the IT Service Desk (phone 4357, Teams "IT Help", or the self-service portal https://it.acme.example).

Verification and Confirmation

After installation-whether performed by the user or the Service Desk-confirm that the software is functional and properly licensed before closing the ticket.

1. 1. Verify the user's identity and device compliance (Intune compliance status, BitLocker/FileVault encryption, and latest policy sync).
2. 2. Search the approved software list in Intune -> Apps -> All apps to confirm whether the requested title is present and assigned to the user/group.
3. 3. If the app is present but not installed, trigger a remote reinstall via Intune -> Devices -> select device -> **Sync** then **Retry install**. Monitor the installation status in the Intune console.
4. 4. If the app is absent from the list, check whether a license exists in the Microsoft 365 admin center or the relevant vendor portal (e.g., Adobe, JetBrains). Assign the license if available and re-attempt step?3.
5. 5. If no license is available or the app requires security review, create a ticket in the Application Support queue with the following details: user name, device ID, requested software version, justification, and any error codes. Tag the ticket for Security Operations review if the application is classified as high-risk.
6. 6. Inform the user of the expected timeline (standard review <=?2 business days) and provide a temporary workaround if possible (e.g., using the web version of the tool).

Verification Steps

These quick checks help ensure a successful rollout.

1. 1. Launch the application and verify it opens without prompting for activation or a trial notice.
2. 2. Check the Help -> About menu to confirm the version matches the approved release.
3. 3. For licensed products, verify that the license status shows as activated (e.g., Adobe License Status dialog, Python package manager shows no trial restrictions).
4. 4. Confirm that the application appears in Intune -> Devices -> **Apps** list with a status of **Installed**.
5. 5. Document the outcome in the ticket and close it with resolution "Installed approved software from Company Portal."

When to Escalate

Escalation ensures that licensing, security, or policy issues are handled by the appropriate specialists.

When to escalate

Escalate to the Application Support team (or Security Operations for high-risk software) when: the requested application is not on the approved list and no license can be assigned; the installation repeatedly fails despite correct licensing and Intune policy sync; or the user requires a version or feature set that is not covered by the current approved build. Include in the escalation ticket: user name, employee ID, device hostname, Intune device ID, requested software name and version, exact error messages, screenshots of the Company Portal view, and any license assignment details. Mark the ticket priority P2 (High) unless the software is deemed critical to business continuity, in which case raise to P1.

Keywords: approved software list, Company Portal, Intune install, software request, Python install, Adobe Reader, Visual Studio Code, licensing, Software Center failed, application not available, access denied 0x80070005, admin credentials prompt, security review, license assignment, Intune policy sync, BitLocker, FileVault, Endpoint Manager